

Strengths and weaknesses of the game you developed

Multiplayer implementation was absolutely exceptional. It was genuinely amazing having someone dedicated to working on the backend of the networking and making it easier for us, less technical people, to implement networking functionality into our code. This excelled our progress with networking, although having everyone do the network was a challenge since not everyone wanted to learn that. This did take the heavy load from our dedicated networker, but this did slow down as some implementations we made weren't in consideration of multiplayer.

The lack of project management on my behalf contributed heavily to our game's final product. I did not set any hard deadlines for people, which led to tasks assigned taking longer than they should and being put on the side. Not having a discussion beforehand of mockup methods and general class wasted time in the future when people have to refactor code to align with someone else's code. Having no clear deadlines led to us not having enough time to properly play tests to see if our loop, mechanics, and systems were actually fun. With the limited playtesting we did get from pairs, people seemed to enjoy the multiplayer aspect and the cooking game loop derived from similar games in the genre. This weakness of management hindered our polishing of the final product.

Best parts of the game/development process of the game

During development, we were consistent in holding meetings with everyone, discussing our issues, bugs, and progress we had made throughout each week. We maintained a week of in-person meetings with everyone, and some weeks we extended that to two per week, one in-person and the other online. This keeps us accountable for the work we have done. Using Discord and GitHub for tracking issues and communicating greatly improved our workflow. We used issues to keep track of tasks we were working on during the week. Although most of us didn't utilise issues and project planning as much as we should have, when we did use them, it helped us keep on track.

In general, I enjoyed learning Godot. At the start, it was quite the learning curve from Unreal blueprints and the general workflow. Since this was all of our real first time doing 3D Godot, it was comforting that we were all in unfamiliar territory, but could lean on people's expertise in the engine.